

Citizenship

Plutarch
Current Events
American Government
Community Read Alouds
Ethics





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Plutarch: Grades 6-8, American Government: Grade 7, Ethics: Part 1, Current Events: Grades 5-8, Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

About Plutarch: Grades 6-8

Plutarch's Lives is a collection of biographies written 2,000 years ago, which has influenced prominent thinkers from Montaigne to Bacon to Shakespeare. Plutarch's stories are often difficult to read (and are therefore often dropped by teachers), but their value to help students evaluate the characteristics that define a good citizen cannot be overstated. The lesson plans will contain additional support to what is already included in the Anne White guides.

About Current Events: Grades 5-8

Students are exposed to current events by reading from a variety of sources and having age-appropriate conversations with teachers. Topics such as scientific discoveries, the arts, and human interest stories are generally suitable.

About American Government: Grade 7

Students will gain a better understanding of the foundation of American democracy as they learn about the key principles of the Constitution, including the separation of powers, checks and balances, and the responsibilities of each branch of government. There will be a special focus on the Bill of Rights so students understand their rights as citizens and the limits of the government. Supplemental material is provided through articles, videos, and Supreme Court cases. Students will engage with these ideas using their Citizenship notebook.

About Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12

This is meant to be a read-aloud for all ages to enjoy together in the afternoon at least 1 time a week. We encourage you to choose a book that is specific to your region. However, we will offer some suggestions in the Grades 1-3 Literature lessons and Grades 4+ Citizenship lessons. The suggested book titles will be available June 1st in the lesson plans.

About Ethics: Part 1

One of Mason's main pillars is that the student is born a "person." Ourselves is the book in which she defines that term, and it is the only volume she wrote directly to students. The book is divided into two parts. We use Ourselves Part 1 in Grades 7-9 and Part 2 in Grades 10-11, as Mason did in her own schools. In these books, students will explore characteristics shared by all Image-Bearers and learn how to guard against good servants becoming bad masters with Charlotte Mason's text written directly to students.



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

Students in 5th grade or new to Plutarch may want to take the Beginner's Track, which covers the life of Publicola over two terms. It is advisable to have students read Beesly's Stories From the History of Rome and complete one year of Shakespeare before beginning Plutarch.

American Government: Grade 7

If 8th-grade students have not taken this course or studied the Constitution, they should consider taking it instead of the 8th-grade option.

Ethics: Part 1

Ourselves by Charlotte Mason is scheduled over five years. In a multi-age context, students can jump into the book wherever the class is reading. Otherwise, students should begin the book in Part 1.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
6-8+	Plutarch: Grades 6-8 1 time/week 30 min	Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed. The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)
5-8	Current Events: Grades 5-8 1+ time/week 15 min	
7	American Government: Grade 7 1 time/week 30 min	Your Rugged Constitution
1-12	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 1+ time/week 20 min+	
7+	Ethics: Part 1 1 time/week 25 min	Ourselves: Book 1

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

- ☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.
- ☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.
- ☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- ☐ Watch the video in Quick Links about teaching Plutarch.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)

American Government: Grade 7



Your Rugged Constitution

Ethics: Part 1



Ourselves: Book 1



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Plutarch: Grades 6-8

- ∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- ∞ [The Pour Over | Subscribe](#)
- ∞ [The World and Everything In It](#)
- ∞ [World Watch \(Paid Subscription Required\)](#)
- ∞ [The Sift](#)
- ∞ [BBC](#)
- ∞ [Teaching Kids News \(CA\)](#)
- ∞ [1Jour1Actu \(in French\)](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 1

Country of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Charlotte Mason, the author of this text, felt that the available material on formal formation during her time was severely lacking; what was available she considered unsuitably preachy and uninteresting. She felt compelled to write an approachable but challenging alternative, which is the text for this course: Ourselves.

Mason believed that before we could fully consider our duties to God, country, and others, we must first know and begin to understand ourselves, including the possibilities and risks inherent in all of us. Self-knowledge, in her view, was the inevitable prerequisite to self-direction, which is why she aptly named the first and second "Books" of Ourselves after each.

In order to present these ideas in an interesting way, she used the allegory of a country and its government. In her own words: "The realised self of each of us is a distressfully poor thing, and yet upon its insight and its action depends the redemption of that greater self, whose limitations no man has discovered. It is, to use a figure, as the relation between a country and its government. The country is ever greater than the governing body; and yet, for its development, the former must depend upon the latter."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-2 "Do ye not" - "be a hero."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Begin drawing a map of Mansoul using information from today's reading.

• DEFINITIONS

landes: an old English word for lands

WEEK 1

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

The Declaration of Independence

→ INTRO

What do we celebrate on July 4th each year?

→ VIEW

Watch this informative video about the Declaration of Independence.

∞ Video Link: The Declaration of Independence

→ READ

Now, use the link below to read parts of The Declaration of Independence. You don't need to read the whole thing. Try to read something from every section. Here is some background information about it. This document contains five parts. "The introduction 'declares' why the colonies need to be independent of the British Empire. Next, the Preamble explains views about freedom and self-rule. The First Section of the Body states the abuses of King George III, and the Second Section explains how the Colonists appealed in vain to the king, concluding that the United Colonies have the right to be free from the tyrant." (Painless American Government, p.23).

∞ Document Link: The Declaration of Independence

→ DISCUSS

Find a statement from the Declaration of Independence that you found interesting and discuss it with your teacher.

• EXTRA HELPING

View the home of Thomas Jefferson

∞ **Image Link:** Monticello on Carter Mountain

• IMPORTANT DATES

Declaration of Independence (1776)

WEEK 1

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 1

Introduction and Lesson 1 Julius Caesar p. 1-12

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students. Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

∞ Link: Retelling of Caesar (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)

→INTRO HAVE YOU EVER HEARD OF JULIUS CAESAR? IF SO, WHAT DO YOU KNOW ABOUT HIM?

→VIEW

∞ Image Link: Julius Caesar

Map Resource: Historical Atlas, p.14-15

→LOCATE

Take 1-2 minutes to look over the map of The Roman Republic and the surrounding "world" in Caesar's time. Find Rome in Italy. Find the Aegean Sea between the province of Asia and Achaea. This is the coastline where the pirates operated. Find Bithynia on the southern shore of the Black Sea where Caesar went after his release. These are the places where a teenager on the wrong side of Roman politics spent his first years away from home.

★ TEACHER TIP

∞ **Link:** To keep track of all of the characters in the story, it may be helpful for your student to sketch a chart or list of some kind in their citizenship notebook.

★ TEACHER NOTE

∞ **Link:** Watch this overview video to help with the Character Simulator (Link coming soon)

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson One, Parts One - Three, p.9-12. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

In the introduction of Lesson One, we learn that "young Julius Caesar was on the wrong side. Most people in that position would have stayed hidden or at least tried to live quietly." (p. 7) In a situation where staying silent means comfort and safety, what factors or beliefs might make a person decide that standing up is worth the risk?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you found yourself on the "wrong side" of a big decision at school or with your friends, and staying quiet was the only way to stay safe and comfortable, how would you decide which ideas are worth being "exiled" for and which ones are just you being stubborn?

WEEK 1

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 1

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 2

Country of Mansoul

📁 Materials: Ourselves

→ RECAP

In the last lesson, we were introduced to the country of Mansoul. How would you describe it in your own words?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.3-4 "There are libraries" - "rich and beautiful."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue work on map of Mansoul.

• DEFINITIONS

cricket: a bat and ball game that originated and is popular in England

• COMPOSITION

How is Mansoul like a rich and beautiful land?

WEEK 2

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Types of Government

📁 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Declaration of Independence?

→ INTRO

What kind of government does the United States have? There are three types of governments: 1. Autocracy- one ruler has absolute control and decision-making power 2. Oligarchy-a small group of landowners, military officers, or wealthy business people control the government institutions. 3. Democracy- The citizens together rule themselves (It comes from two Greek words—demos (the people) and kratos (rule of power). The Constitution establishes a federal democratic republic form of government. That is, we have a union of 50 sovereign States. It is a democracy because people govern themselves. It is representative because people choose elected officials by free and secret ballot. It is a republic because the government derives its power from the people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-12

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video for an explanation of how power is divided into the three branches of government.

∞ **Video Link:** How Power is Divided

• COMPOSITION

What were some of the issues the new country had to deal with? Why was a new governing document needed?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Signing of the Constitution (1787)

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

∞ Image Link: Copy of the Constitution in The National Archives

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the map of the forms of government throughout the world. You may need an atlas to identify the specific countries.

∞ Map Link: Map: Forms of Government

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Copy down the three branches of government shown on p.12 (illustrations optional). Leave plenty of room under each so you can add more details later.

WEEK 2

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 2

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 2 Julius Caesar p. 12-17

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we learn so far about Caesar from the first reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Hither Spain and Farther Spain on the western edge of the map. Both are already "Roman Pink." Find the Alps. This is the route Caesar traveled when he passed through a tiny village and said, "For my part, I had rather be the chiefest man here, than the second person in Rome." (p. 15, The Plutarch Project)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful to write definitions into the text, so you do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Two, Parts One - Three, p.14-17. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a young officer who rode with Caesar when he passed through a tiny village in the Alps and said he would rather be the first man there than the second in Rome. What do you think about that comment?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Explain how you might distinguish between a person who wants to do great things and a person who simply wants to be the greatest.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The map shows the world in 31 B.C., shortly after Caesar's time. You will notice Italy is shaded pink; while it was the Roman Homeland and not a province, it is colored here to show it was under central Roman control.

While all of Gaul is pink on this map, remember that when Caesar began his command, only the southern tip belonged to Rome. His campaigns are what eventually brought the rest of that territory into the Empire.

• DEFINITIONS

Pontifex Maximus: There were numerous levels and types of priesthood in Rome and throughout the rest of Italy; and these positions carried political as well as spiritual authority.

WEEK 2

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 2

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

• DEFINITIONS

incendiary: a device or strategy intended to start a fire

Föhn: a strong, warm air that comes down off the Alps and is known to both melt snow and spread wildfires

• COMPOSITION

What are ways a flame could come from a foreign land?

WEEK 3

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 3

Perils of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the culture of Mansoul from our last reading? How is it similar to where you live? How is it different?

Today, we will begin a new chapter called The Perils of Mansoul. A peril is a serious or immediate danger. Let's see what dangers are lurking for Mansoul.

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.5-6 "You are thinking" - "fires and lights."

WEEK 3

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

Congress, House of Representatives

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The Constitution has become the world's oldest charter of national government in continuous use. With just 27 amendments (additions), it continues to provide the framework for our country.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-23

- What do you notice about the differences between the House of Representatives and Senate?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

- Go back to the chart you made in week 2 and add more information about Congress from this section, including requirements.

- Using the information from this map link, start another chart that lists the people currently in Congress from your state who hold these government positions.

∞ Map Link: Map of Members of Congress

- See the example in Citizenship Notebook (Quick Links)

WEEK 3

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 3

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 3 Julius Caesar p. 17-24

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and pre-read the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Transalpine Gaul and the Rhine River marking the boundary between Gaul and Germania. Notice that Germania is entirely outside the Roman pink. The is the boundary Caesar was about to push.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Three, Parts One - Three, p.19-23. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who has watched him for days while ill and exhausted. Tonight he is sick again. What do you think about his choices while chronically ill? (p. 22)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Describe the different ways Caesar and his companions responded to the dish served by their host in Milan. (p. 23)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Germania was entirely outside Roman control.

- The Rhine was the line Caesar pushed against, even crossing it twice (in 55 and 53 BC) to build famous bridges and conduct show of force expeditions.

- Despite these incursions, Rome never successfully turned the main body of Germania into a permanent province, even in the centuries following Caesar

• CULTURAL CONNECTION

Sweet Ointment: also translated "oil of perfume" or "myrrh." It appears that Valerius Leo hadn't just pulled out the wrong bottle of salad dressing, rather that he was trying to show off his wealth. The reference to the host's want of breeding seems to confirm that.

WEEK 3

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 3

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

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Term 1

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 4

Perils of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What perils put the country of Mansoul at risk? How? What, if anything, could be done to prevent them?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.6-8 "Sometimes there is" - "to its duties."

• DEFINITIONS

ministry: a specific department within the government

Prime Minister: the head of the British government

• COMPOSITION

Tell about some of the Perils of Mansoul and tell which are the most perilous for you.

WEEK 4

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 4

The Senate

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The "Great Compromise" allowed for large and small states to have equal representation in the Senate. We will read more today about the Great Compromise and the requirements for being a Senator.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.24-33

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Read this article about the effects of "The Great Compromise" today.

∞ Article Link: 3-Minute Civics: Was the 'Great Compromise' great?

• Does the "great compromise" still make sense today?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Great Compromise

WEEK 4

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 4

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 4 Julius Caesar p. 24-30

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find the Rhine separating Gaul from Germania. Find Cisalpine Gaul south of the Alps. Trace north from Cisalpine Gaul all the way to the Rhine. This is the distance those men were willing to march.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Four, Parts One - Four, p.26-30. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Caesar "never failed to dismiss all with present pledges of his kindness in hand, and further hopes for the future." (p. 29) As one of his soldiers, you've just watched him march over a bridge of fallen soldiers. Now, he stands before you, gives you gold, and speaks of the future with hope. How do you make sense of the leader you saw at the river and the generous, hopeful man standing in front of you now?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar "commanded them that were afraid, that they should depart home, and not put themselves in danger against their wills." (p. 27-28) How would you respond if you were one of the "young gentlemen of noble houses of Rome, who thought to have gone to the wars with him as only for their pleasure and gain" and Caesar was sending you home? (p. 27)

WEEK 4

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 4

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 5

Government of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

In the last lesson, we read about several more perils to Mansoul: Plague, Flood, Famine, Discord, and Darkness. What causes these perils, and what are some of the consequences?

Today, we will be introduced to the government of Mansoul. In the same way that every country must have a form of government, so, too, must a person have an internal "government" that rules them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.III p.9-10 "I must give" - "a human being."

• DEFINITIONS

esquire: similar to a page, a lower servant or assistant to a higher government office

lord: the formal title for a ruler over a particular land or territory

exchequer /eks CHEK er/: the name of the British government department responsible for the collection and management of taxes and revenue; similar to a Treasury

minister: the head of a specific department (ministry) within the government

WEEK 5

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 5

The Senate

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What do you remember about The Great Compromise?

→ INTRO

"As the Constitution's framers sweated and fretted through the Philadelphia summer...the question of impeachment worried Benjamin Franklin. America's elder statesmen feared that without a means to remove a corrupt or incompetent official, the only resort would be assassination. As Franklin put it, this result would leave the political official 'not only deprived of his life but of the opportunity of vindicating his character.' Perhaps he had Julius Caesar and the Roman Senate in mind. Ultimately, the framers agreed with Franklin. There was some debate about which crimes would be impeachable, but the framers left us with 'Treason, Bribery or other High Crimes and Misdemeanors.' Though the first two are pretty clear-cut, the rest of the definition leaves considerably more wiggle room." (The History of American Impeachment, Kenneth Davis, Smithsonian Magazine)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.34-45

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

View this list of individuals impeached by the House of Representatives. How many were Presidents? (Note that President Richard Nixon resigned before he could be impeached.)

∞ Document Link: List of Individuals Impeached by the House of Representatives

- Is "Treason, Bribery or other High Crimes and Misdemeanors" clear enough, or should the Constitution be more clear on why someone can be impeached?

WEEK 5

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 5

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 5 Julius Caesar p. 30-36

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→LOCATE

Find Arverni where Vercingetorix and the Arverni lived. Find Alesia. Notice the rivers and terrain and consider why Caesar chose to build where he did.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Five, Parts One - Two, p.32-36. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Vercingetorix, riding out of the gates of Alesia in full armor to give yourself up. What do you think about the choice you are making?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Look closely at the rivers surrounding Alesia. How might these help a general trying to keep an army from escaping?

WEEK 5

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 5

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 6

Esquires of the Body: Hunger

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the government of Mansoul? Why is it important to understand these powers within a person?

In today's reading, you'll hear the word esquire. In Mason's time, an esquire was often one who received a title (such as "lord") for service to the king. Sometimes they worked for the good of the kingdom, but other times to gain an advantage over others. How would that affect the kingdom? In this book, Mason gives the name "esquire" to the appetites of the body. As we read, keep this in mind.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.I p.11-13 "We will first" - "two hours long."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Start a chart of the government of Mansoul that includes the King, the Prime Minister, and the Esquires. As you read, tell what their duties are and how each has the potential to damage the kingdom of Mansoul when they try to become too powerful.

WEEK 6

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 6

Rules for Congress

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

This section outlines several rules for Congress. Do all of these rules still make sense today?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-53

The Congressional Record can now be viewed online. Look at a recent session and read the prayer that is recorded for that day.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- ∞ Document Link: Congressional Record (Click "Entire Issue" for the date you want to view.)
- Did any of the rules for Congress surprise you?
- Do you think it is still important for sessions to be in person, or should Congress be allowed to meet and vote online?

WEEK 6

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 6

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 6 Julius Caesar p. 36-42

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ **RECAP**

What happened in the last reading?

→ **LOCATE**

Find the Rubicon. Locate Brundisium on the Adriatic coast. Find Dyrrhachium across the Ionian Sea and notice the distance Caesar was asking his army to cross. Consider the risk of moving a massive force across that stretch of the Ionian Sea while being hunted by an enemy fleet.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ, NARRATE**

Lesson Six, Parts One - Two, p. 38-42. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**

You are Asinius Pollio, standing beside Caesar at the Rubicon while he talks through what crossing will mean. What do you think as you listen to him? (p. 41-42)

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)**

On the banks of the Rubicon, Caesar's abstract plan shifts to the reality of the action. Describe what he sees and feels in that moment of doubt as he considers the "desperateness of his attempt." (p. 41)

WEEK 6

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 6

Tracker:

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 7

Esquires of the Body: Hunger

Materials: Ourselves

→ **INTRO**

What is meant by "Esquires of the Body"? Describe in your own words.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Pt.I Ch.I p.13-14 "But, you will say" - "his good tidings."

- **CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK**

Continue adding to government chart.

• **DEFINITIONS**
pudding: dessert

hampers: packages of food

• **COMPOSITION**
How is hunger both a servant and a master?

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 7

Methods of Passing Laws

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Only about 10% of proposed bills become laws. Checks and balances are meant to help ensure no branch has too much power and can act too hastily.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.54-63

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the current bills that have been submitted by Congress. Click on a couple of them to see what they are about.

∞ Document Link: Most Viewed Bills

• What might happen without a system of checks and balances?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a simple diagram showing how a bill becomes a law. This example is for state governments.

∞ Image Link: Chart of How a Bill Becomes a Law

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch the classic video about the way a bill becomes a law.

∞ Video Link: How A Bill Becomes A Law

WEEK 7

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 7

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 7 Julius Caesar p. 42-50

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Trace the route Caesar used to move through Italy in sixty days without a major battle. Find Corfinium where Domitius surrendered. Locate Brundisium where Pompey escaped by sea.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Seven, Parts One - Four, p.45-49. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Labienus, Caesar's most trusted general for ten years, the night you walked out of his camp for the last time. What do you think about the man you are leaving? (p. 46)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar said, "Time of war and law are two things." (p. 47) What does he mean?

WEEK 7

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 7

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 8

Esquires of the Body: Thirst

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

According to our last lesson, how are we to avoid Greediness? Why is it important to do so?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.II p.15-17 "Another most serviceable" - "delicious it is."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to government chart.

• DEFINITIONS

forms: the structure of the British school system, similar to grades

WEEK 8

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 8

Powers of Congress

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How do you think Congress gets the money needed to run the government?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.64-75

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Watch this short video about the national debt and then view the U.S. National Debt Clock.

∞ Video Link: What is the National Debt?

∞ Image Link: U.S. National Debt Clock

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, list a few items that fall under the power of Congress that stood out to you the most.

• EXTRA HELPING

The Internal Revenue Service

∞ **Video Link:** The IRS Origin

Story (especially to 1:30)

WEEK 8

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 8

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 8 Julius Caesar p. 50-56

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find the city of Rome in Italy and cross the Adriatic Sea to the province of Macedonia, the rugged region where the Battle of Pharsalus was fought. Find Pharsalus. Trace the coastline south to Alexandria and the Kingdom of the Ptolemies, where the defeated Pompey eventually fled for refuge. These are the locations where the future of the Roman world was decided as Caesar pursued his rival across the Mediterranean.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One - Three, p.51-56. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who ran to meet him when he returned to shore, and you are angry. Your general just risked his life sneaking across a war zone in a twelve-oar boat dressed as a slave, without telling anyone. What specifically bothers you about what he did, and what does your reaction say about what you believe a leader owes the people who follow him?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar's plan to aim at the faces of the young cavalrymen worked because he thought carefully about who they actually were, not just what they were doing on the battlefield. Describe a conflict or disagreement you have had where understanding the other person's specific fears or weaknesses would have changed how you approached the situation.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The writing prompt is slightly uncomfortable by design, because understanding someone's fears in order to respond more effectively sits right on the edge between wisdom and manipulation

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 8

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 9

Esquires: Restlessness and Rest

☐ Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about Thirst. How can Thirst be a source of danger for Mansoul?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.III p.18-20 "I hardly know" - "work or play."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK
Continue adding to government chart.

• DEFINITIONS

daemon: As Mason uses it here, it refers to the cruel, evil, and/or destructive manifestation of a quality or trait.

• COMPOSITION

Describe sloth and what its outcome can be in the body.

WEEK 9

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 9

Powers of Congress

☐ Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-83

Are there any powers of Congress surprising or confusing to you?

→ VIEW

In 2018, someone applied for the 10 millionth patent. A new patent design was created. Check out the video and timeline of important patents that were issued.

∞ Video Link: 10 Million Patents

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, list a few more items that fall under the power of Congress that stood out to you.

WEEK 9

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 9

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 9 Julius Caesar p. 57-62

☐ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Alexandria on its Mediterranean coast. This is where Caesar spent months managing a dangerous court, a burning library, a treacherous eunuch, and a queen smuggled in through a castle gate in a bundle. He nearly drowned here. Move northeast into Syria, which Caesar passed through on his way to deal with the next problem before the Egyptian one was fully settled. Find Pontus on the southern shore of the Black Sea. This is where Pharnaces had overrun Roman territory while Caesar was occupied in Alexandria. Caesar arrived, fought, and sent a three-word letter back to Rome. The whole thing was over before the letter arrived.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Nine, Parts One - Three, p.58-61. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Pompey's soldiers who has just been taken prisoner and is now being folded into Caesar's legions. Yesterday you were fighting against this man. Today, he is your general. What do you do with that, and what would you need to see from him before you trusted him? (p. 58-59)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Caesar "daily saved the lives of some of his countrymen that bore arms against him" and considered this the greatest pleasure of his victory. Think of a conflict, whether between people, groups, or ideas, where the most meaningful thing a winner could do afterward was show restraint or generosity. What makes that kind of choice hard, and what makes it worth it? (p. 59)

"Veni, Vidi, Vici" worked because it was short, precise, and matched the reality of what had actually happened. Think of a time when you had to report something, explain yourself, or sum up a complicated situation for someone else. What is lost when we say too much, and what is lost when we say too little? (p. 61)

WEEK 9

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 9

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 10

Esquires of the Body: Chastity

☐ Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

How can restlessness be helpful? How can rest be helpful? How can each be destructive?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.IV p.21-23 "We have seen" - "to do so."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK
Continue adding to government chart.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the sensitive content in this section that talks about chastity.

WEEK 10

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 10

Powers of Congress

☐ Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.84-93

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, continue to list a few more items that fall under the power of Congress that stood out to you.



Term 1

WEEK 10

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 10

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 10 Julius Caesar p. 62-69

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Sicily, where Caesar camped on the seashore in winter to cut off any thought of delay, then trace his crossing south to the African coast and the battle at Thapsus, where three camps fell in a single day. Follow him back to Rome for the triumphs and the honors, then west to Spain and the battle at Munda, where Pompey's sons nearly killed him, and back to Rome again. He covered all of it inside two years.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Ten, Parts One - Three, p. 64-68. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's friends who has just urged him to accept a personal bodyguard, and he has refused, saying it is "better to die once than always to be afraid of death." You believe there are real plots against him. How would you respond to his answer? (p. 68)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar put a man of the right family name at the head of his troops specifically to counter an oracle his enemies believed in. He may have been mocking it or he may have been sincere; Plutarch says it is hard to tell. Think about a time when you did something that could have been interpreted two very different ways depending on who was watching. Do your intentions fully determine the meaning of an action, or does it matter how others read it? (p. 65)

WEEK 10

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 10

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH-UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 11

Powers Denied the Federal Government & States

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Have you heard the Latin term "habeas corpus"? Its literal meaning is "you may have the body". We will find out today why this unusual term is included in our Constitution.



Term 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.94-109

→ **VIEW & DISCUSS**
President Lincoln suspended the writ of habeas corpus during the Civil War. Watch this short video and discuss whether his actions were constitutional.
∞ Video Link: Suspending Habeas Corpus

WEEK 11

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 11

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 11 Julius Caesar p. 69-82

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ **RECAP**
What happened in the last reading?

→ **LOCATE**
Find Rome. Now stay there, because that is where all of Lesson 11 takes place. After a life of crossing seas and marching through impassable terrain, the whole lesson fits inside a single city. Find Philippi in Macedonia, where Brutus and Cassius died by their own hands. Trace the distance between those two points.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**
Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ, NARRATE**
Lesson Eleven, Parts One - Three, p. 70-74 and Lesson Twelve, Parts One - Epilogue, p. 77-82. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR, PICK 1**
You are a senator who walked out when Caesar refused to stand up to greet you. You said nothing. You just left. What were you communicating, and do you think he understood it?

You are Caesar in the moment before you cover your face and give up. You have fought off the others. You are still standing. And then you see Brutus. Something finally stops all the fight in you. You have outrun everything your whole life. What is it that you are finally deciding to stop outrunning? (p. 78)

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1**
You have served Caesar since his early campaigns. You have watched him win in Gaul, survive civil war, defeat Pompey, and return to Rome in triumph. He is now planning new campaigns as if none of it happened. What does it feel like to follow a man who cannot stop? What do you think he is still looking for?

The crowd killed Cinna the poet because he had the same name as Cinna the conspirator. He tried to tell them who he was and it made no difference. Think about a situation where a person was judged entirely by something they had no control over. What does that kind of mistake reveal about what happens to people's judgment when they are driven by grief or rage? (p. 80)

WEEK 11

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 11

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**
Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ **LOCATE**
Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ **NOTEBOOK**
Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)



[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

Term 1	
WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Ourselves	
WEEK 12 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Our Rugged Constitution	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 12 30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Exams Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15 → RECAP What happened in the last reading? → VIEW & DISCUSS Answer one of the exam questions. Include as much detail as you can remember.	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 1

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 13

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Last term, we read about the government of Mansoul. Describe what you remember about its King, its Prime Minister, and its Esquires.

Today, we will read about "Pages." These are the assistants, or servants, to the Esquires.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.24-26 "The Esquires" - "fresh or fusty"

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Start a list for each Page and their duties.

• COMPOSITION

Tell how to keep Smell "in good working order."

WEEK 1

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 13

The President and Vice President

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How does someone become president? Is it the person who gets the highest number of votes? There is something called the electoral college that was written into the Constitution that makes it a little more complicated than just getting the most votes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.112-119

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Watch this short video about the Electoral College

∞ Video Link: How the US Electoral College Works

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Add information about the executive branch in your chart.

WEEK 1

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 13

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Introduction and Lesson 1 Agis and Cleomenes p. 84-99

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students. Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

∞ Link: Retelling of Agis and Cleomenes (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)

→INTRO

Have you ever heard of Sparta? If so, what do you know about it? What do you think made Sparta different from other ancient Greek cities?

Map Resource: Historical Atlas, p.7

→LOCATE

Find Sparta in the southern part of Greece, tucked between the Laconian Gulf to the east and the Messenian Gulf to the west. Now find Laconia, the region surrounding Sparta, and Messenia to its west. Find Corinth at the narrow neck of land connecting the southern peninsula to the rest of Greece. Agis's story takes place in this region.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Introduction and Lesson One, Parts One - Two, p. 84-93 and Lesson Two, Parts One - Three, p. 96-99. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR - PICK 1

Agis is not yet twenty years old. He has grown up with wealth and comfort provided by his mother and grandmother, the richest women in Sparta. Plutarch says he "began to spurn against these womanish delights and pleasures" and chose the plain Spartan life instead. Nobody made him do this. What do you think happened inside him, and what does his choice tell you about what kind of person he was becoming? (p. 91)

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Agis's mother and grandmother were the richest women in Sparta and had the most to lose from his reforms. They opposed him at first. Then something changed, and they not only consented but became his most vocal supporters, willing to give up their own wealth for his cause. What do you think changed their minds? What does their behavior tell you about those women? (p. 96)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE) - PICK 1

Agis "openly boasted besides, that he would not desire to be king, but only for the hope he had to restore the ancient Laconian life by his authority." (p. 91) What do you think he meant?

Agisilaus persuaded Agis to cancel the debts first and divide the land later, arguing that doing both at once might cause dangerous commotion. Then, Plutarch reveals his motives, "Agisilaus...having the best lands of any man in the country, and owing a great sum of money besides, would neither pay his debts, not let go his land." (p. 99) Think about the difference between counsel and manipulation. How do you learn to tell the difference when someone gives you advice?

WEEK 1

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 13

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 14

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how Taste is a useful Page to the body. What happens when we pamper it? Why is Smell described as lazy?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.26-28 "There are five" - "cause of the pain."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to lists on Pages.

• DEFINITIONS

Spartan boy: This refers to a story from Sparta where a young boy caught a live fox and hid it in his robes. The fox began to bite and claw him, but the boy was determined to show bravery and refused to move or ask for help until he died from his wounds.

WEEK 2

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 14

Powers & Duties

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How has the role of the President changed since George Washington was first in office? What are some things that might be different for the current president than it was for George Washington?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-129

The President's duties cover a lot of areas and require a lot of decisions. Presidents have a Cabinet, a group of experts in different areas who can inform the President as he makes decisions about what is best for the country. The word Cabinet is not in the Constitution, but "executive departments" are mentioned, which were the basis for the development of the Cabinet. President George Washington had four departments—the State Department (foreign nations), Treasury Department (money matters), War Department (military matters), and Department of Justice (legal matters). Now, the president has 15 executive departments.

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Watch this short video explaining the President's Cabinet.

∞ Video Link: The President's Cabinet

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

- Add information about the role of the president.
- Make a list of at least 4 of the Cabinet positions in the government and who serves in those roles.
- ∞ Document Link: List of Cabinet Members

WEEK 2

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 14

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 3 Agis and Cleomenes p. 100-107

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Megara and Corinth. The narrow strip of land between them is the Isthmus of Corinth, where the sea presses in from both sides (The Saronic Gulf and the Gulf of Corinth). The large peninsula below Corinth is the Peloponnese. Neither label appears on this map, but you can see the shape clearly. Sparta is in the Southern Peloponnese region. This is the route Agis marched north with his young army to assist the Achaeans.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Three, Parts One through Three, p. 102-106. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Agis was led to his death by men pretending to be his friends. When the moment came, he saw a sergeant weeping for him and said, "Good fellow, I pray thee weep not for me, for I am honestest man than they that so shamefully put me to death." (p. 106) He was twenty years old. What do you notice about that moment?

→ WRITE

When the ephor asked if Agis repented of what he had done, he answered that "he would never repent him of so wise and virtuous an enterprise, though he ventured his life for it." (p. 105-106) What do you think about that answer?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This week's lesson may feel heavy for some students. An honorable man dies with integrity.

WEEK 2

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 14

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 15

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how Touch is a good servant to the body, but a bad master.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.28-30 "But, on the other" - "can distinguish."

• DEFINITIONS

mustard poultice: a paste often used to treat chest congestion in Mason's time. If left too long, it can irritate the skin.

drawing room: similar to a living room

James Simpson: a Scottish doctor who first used chloroform as an anesthetic

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Term 2

• **CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK**
Continue adding to lists on Pages.

• **COMPOSITION**
"Do you know how Eyes and No-Eyes went out for a walk?" Tell what followed in the reading.

WEEK 3

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 15 *Powers & Duties*

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **INTRO**

Today we will read about more powers and duties of the President, but we'll also explore why Presidents today may have more power than the Constitution intended.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS** p.130-135

→ **VIEW & DISCUSS**

Watch this video on the expanding powers of the presidency. Stop around the 4:38 mark to allow time for discussion.

∞ Video Link: Is Expanding Presidential Power Bad?

• Do you think Presidents today have more power than the Constitution intended? Why might this be good or bad?

→ **CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK**

Add information about the powers and duties of the president.

WEEK 3

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 15 *30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 4 Agis and Cleomenes p. 107-112*

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ **RECAP**

What happened in the last reading?

→ **LOCATE**

Find Sparta. That's where Lesson 4 takes place.

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ, NARRATE**

Lesson Four, Parts One through Three, p. 109-111. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**

Cleomenes married Agiatis against her will, yet "immediately after he was married unto her, fell greatly in fancy with her, and for compassion's sake he thanked her for the love she bore unto her first husband." (p. 109) What does that tell you about him?

→ **WRITE**

Plutarch says Cleomenes and Agis were alike in many ways, but that Cleomenes had "something of heat and passion always goading him on, and an impetuosity and violence in his eagerness to pursue anything which he thought good and just." (p. 109) Do you think that is a strength or a weakness? Explain your answer.

WEEK 3

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 15 *Tracker: □ □ □ □ □*

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ **INTRO**

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

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Term 2

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 16

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What did Mason mean by it is "good to have little things to put up with?"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.30-32 "Then, as you" - "whom he knows!"

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to lists on Pages.

• DEFINITIONS

tunes: popular songs of the day

WEEK 4

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 16

More Powers & Duties

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the duties of the President and how they have changed? Today we will read more about those duties.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.136-141

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Visit The White House website "Briefing Room". Pick a recent press briefing or speech to read.

∞ Document Link: The White House Briefing Room

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Add information about the powers and duties of the president.

WEEK 4

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 16

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 5 Agis and Cleomenes p. 112-117

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Arcadia, the highland region in the center of the peninsula. Find Argos to its east and Mantinea within it. This is the terrain Cleomenes is moving through in Lesson 5.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Five, Parts One through Four, p. 114-117 Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch says that when Archidamus was murdered, Cleomenes and his friends "were most blamed, as having forced his consent." (p. 115) What do you think that means?

→ WRITE

After killing Lydiadas in battle, Cleomenes "caused it to be brought unto him, and putting a purple robe upon it, and a crown on his head, sent it in this array unto the very gates of the city of Megalopolis." (p. XX) What does that tell you about Cleomenes?

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Term 2

WEEK 4

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 16

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 5

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 17

Ourselves

☐ Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

How are Sight and Hearing sources of joy? Explain the statement, "The more we listen, the more we hear."

Today, we will begin a new part of our book. We will be reading about all of the parts that comprise our whole selves: our bodies, minds, hearts, and souls.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.I p.33-34 "When we think" - "the Government."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Create a chart with four columns labeled Body, Mind, Heart, and Soul. Record important ideas in the appropriate column after each reading.

WEEK 5

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 17

Federal Courts & Judges

☐ Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.144-147

- How does a case end up at the Supreme Court? Only about 1% of cases that appeal to the Supreme Court are chosen to be argued before the justices.
- ∞ Article Link: Supreme Court Information

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Watch this video that explains the process of how a case ends up in the Supreme Court.

∞ Video Link: How a Case Ends up in the Supreme Court.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Add information about the Judicial Branch.

• EXTRA HELPING

Marbury v. Madison was the Supreme Court case that established judicial review. Judicial review is the role of the courts in interpreting law according to the Constitution.

∞ Video Link: Marbury v. Madison

WEEK 5

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 17

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 6 Agis and Cleomenes p. 118-123

☐ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→LOCATE

Find Sparta. Now find the surrounding region of Laconia. To the north is Arcadia, to the east is Argolis, to the west is Messenia. These are the regions Cleomenes must hold together as king.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

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Term 2

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Six, Parts One through Two, p. 119-122. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a citizen of Sparta watching Cleomenes give his speech and then immediately give up all his own wealth before asking anyone else to. "Himself first, with his step-father, Megistonus, and his friends, gave up all their wealth into one public stock, and all the other citizens followed the example." (p. 120) What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

Cleomenes believed "there was no other difference betwixt a friend and a mercenary: but that the one is won with money, and the other with civility and good entertainment." (p. 122) Do you agree?

WEEK 5

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 17

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 18

My Lord Intellect

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why is it important to understand our "inner" selves? Explain the differences between Self-Control, Self-Knowledge, and Self-Reverence.

Today, we will read about a new member of the government, the Lord Intellect (equivalent to the Foreign Secretary in the U.K., the Secretary of State in the U.S., or the Minister of Foreign Affairs in Canada). This official's role is to talk with representatives from other countries and work out problems peacefully.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.35-37 "To begin with" - "King had gone."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Add the Foreign Secretary to chart of government officials started in Lesson 6.

• DEFINITIONS

kinetoscope: a type of early motion picture device designed for one person

WEEK 6

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 18

Cases in Federal Court

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.148-155

How would you describe treason? Is it criticizing the government?

→ VIEW

Look through the list of Supreme Court Justices and scan their biographies. You will be writing some information about them in your notebook.

∞ Video Link: Current Members of the Supreme Court

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have more questions about the Supreme Court, there is a list of frequently asked questions on their website.

∞ **Link:** FAQ about Supreme Court

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Term 2

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write the names of the current Supreme Court Justices, when they began, which President nominated them and anything else you find interesting from their bio.

WEEK 6

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 18

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 7 Agis and Cleomenes p. 123-127

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Corinth at the top of the Peloponnese. Find Argos to its south. Find the Isthmus of Corinth (see Lesson 15). Cleomenes is moving across the northern Peloponnese, winning city after city, until the question of the Isthmus becomes the question of Greece.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Seven, Parts One through Two, p. 124-127. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch pauses the story to say he writes about Aratus's failure "not out of any design to disgrace Aratus, for in many things he showed himself a true lover of Greece, and a great man; but to make us see the frailty and weakness of man's nature." (p. 126) He is telling you directly how to read what just happened. What does it mean when the biographer steps into the story and tells you what to think? Does it change how you receive it?

→ WRITE

You are a Greek citizen watching Aratus bring Antigonos and the Macedonians into the Peloponnese. Plutarch calls it "a practice far dishonest for a Grecian, very infamous for himself, but most dishonourable for the former noble acts he had done." (p. 126) What do you think about that?

WEEK 6

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 18

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 19

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why is Intellect given the title the "Foreign Secretary" of Mansoul? Describe his job duties.

Today, we will read about Philosophy, which is the study of knowledge and reality. How do you know something is true?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.37-39 "We see, too" - "ease for Mansoul."

• COMPOSITION

Explain how Imagination can be a good companion in travels OR Tell about the land of Mathematics.

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Term 2

WEEK 7

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 19

State Duties to Other States

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

As a republic, we are not just one big country but also a union, or group, of individual states. Today we will read about some of the ways the states interact.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.158-163

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Article IV Explained (Stop video at 3:04 or watch further as time permits.)

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Add the "wedding cake" example of Federalism from today's video to your notebook.

WEEK 7

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 19

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 8 Agis and Cleomenes p. 128-133

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Corinth, Sicyon, and Argos. Now trace south to Sparta. Cleomenes had made himself "master of all Peloponnesus, and now lost all again in as short a time." (p. 132, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One through Four, p. 129-133. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the men retreating with Cleomenes when news arrives that his wife has died. Plutarch says "he gave not place unto his sorrow, neither did grief overcome his noble courage, but he used the selfsame voice, apparel, and countenance, that he did before." (p. 133) What do you think about that?

→ WRITE

You are in Argos when the city revolts against Cleomenes because he was "not releasing them from their debts as they expected." (p. 132) What do you think about that?

WEEK 7

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 19

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

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Term 2

WEEK 8

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 20

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about the domains of History, Mathematics, and Philosophy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.39-41 "Perhaps the least" - "by this test."

WEEK 8

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 20

New States & Federal Territories

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Last time we read about some ways states interact with each other. Today we will see an example of how an amendment can greatly affect those interactions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.164-169

→ VIEW

View the list of US Territories. Then view the map of where these territories are located. Can you make any speculations based on their locations?

∞ Document Link: US Territories

∞ Map Link: US Territories Map

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the rules that exist to keep peace between the states.

WEEK 8

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 20

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 9 Agis and Cleomenes p. 133-138

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Megalopolis in Arcadia. Now find the middle prong of the peninsula between the Messenian Gulf and the Laconian Gulf. The tip of that prong, not labeled on this map, is Taenarus, where Cratesiclea boarded a ship for Egypt. Find Cythera, the small island just off that tip.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Nine, Parts One through Two, p. 135-138. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the soldiers who watched Cleomenes take Megalopolis. He had "taken strict care that the city should not be plundered" before offering it back to its citizens. When they refused, he destroyed it. (p. 138) What do you think about what you witnessed?

→ WRITE

You are standing at the temple door watching Cratesiclea say goodbye to her son before boarding a ship for Egypt as a hostage. She tells him, "O King of Lacedaemon, let no man see for shame, when we come out of the temple, that we have wept and dishonoured Sparta. For that only is in our power, and for the rest, as it pleaseth the gods, so let it be." (p. 135) What do you think about what she chose to say?

★ TEACHER NOTE

"Ptolemy (#1)...promised him aid, but upon demand to have his mother and children in pledge."

Important Vocabulary - in pledge: as hostages.

1. They were collateral: They were the price for ships and money.

2. They were high-ranking: Only the King's own mother and children were valuable enough to secure the alliance.

3. They were voluntary (in spirit): Cratesiclea views herself not as a victim, but as a Spartan citizen fulfilling a mission that is "profitable for Sparta."

WEEK 8

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 20

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make

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Term 2

sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 9

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 21

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the Kingdom of Literature. How can we recognize Literature?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.41-42 "There is another" - "ear or our eye."

• COMPOSITION

How is the Beauty Sense used well?

WEEK 9

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 21

The Making of Amendments

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

We saw last reading how an amendment can change the way we do things. We will dig more into amendments and how they are made today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.172-179

COMPOSITION PROMPT

- Why do you think it is so hard to add an amendment to the Constitution?
- Why did the framers of the Constitution add the clause so that there could be amendments added?

WEEK 9

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 21

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 10 Agis and Cleomenes p. 138-143

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 7

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→LOCATE

Find Argos and the territory around it, where Cleomenes marched twice to shame Antigonus into fighting or force him to lose face. Now find Sellasia, just north of Sparta. This is where the final battle took place, almost within sight of home.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Ten, Parts One through Three, p. 139-143. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are fighting beside Cleomenes at Sellasia when his brother's flank collapses. You hear him cry out, "Alas, good brother, thou art but slain, yet thou diest valiantly, and honestly, and thy death shall be a worthy example unto all posterity." (p. 142) He is still fighting when he says it. Why do you think Plutarch chose to record his exact words?

→ WRITE

You are one of the men who retreated with Cleomenes from Sellasia. You watched him walk back into Sparta, advise the citizens to yield, lean against a pillar to collect his thoughts, and then sail away. What do you think about the man you followed? (p. 143)

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 9

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 21

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 22

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why does Intellect need the Beauty Sense as a second companion? What service does the Beauty Sense provide?

Today's reading uses the word "simulation." Do you know what a simulation is? [the imitation of a situation or a process]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.42-44 "But, like all" - "weary slave."

• DEFINITIONS

marks: the British word for grades

WEEK 10

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 22

The Supremacy of the Constitution

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In our reading today, we will read about our government paying back debt and abiding by its treaties. A treaty is a formal agreement between countries. Paying back money and keeping to our agreements are important parts of building trust, whether with other people or other nations.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.182-189

What do you think the decision of our government to pay back the full amount of debt says about the kind of character our founders wanted for our country?

WEEK 10

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 22

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 11 Agis and Cleomenes p. 143-148

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 10-11

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find the Peloponnesus (p. 10, Alexander's Empire). From the southeastern tip of that peninsula, trace a line southeast across the open Mediterranean Sea, passing just to the west of the island of Crete, until you reach Libya and Alexandria on the coast of Egypt. This is the voyage Cleomenes made after his final defeat at Sellasia. He left behind everything he knew to arrive at a foreign court in Alexandria to ask for help from a king who owed him nothing.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Therycion's speech and Cleomenes's reply are a genuine philosophical debate, not a simple case of one man being right and one wrong. Therycion is not a coward; he is making an argument about honor and the limits of hope. Cleomenes is not dismissing death; he is making an argument about the difference between dying with purpose and dying to escape. Let students sit with the difficulty of that before asking who they think is right.

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Eleven, Parts One through Three, p. 145-148. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are standing on the deck of a ship looking back at the disappearing coast of Greece. The war is lost. Your home is occupied. Therycion turns to you, hand on his sword, and argues that living as a "fugitive" in Egypt is a fate worse than death. Cleomenes disagrees, calling suicide a "cowardly" escape from the hard work of hope. Discuss both sides of the argument. Do you think one of these men is correct? (p. 145-146)

→ WRITE

"King Ptolemy (#1), at his first coming, gave Cleomenes no special good, but indifferent entertainment. But when, upon trial, he found him a man of deep sense and great reason...conversation carried with it a noble and becoming grace...he was ashamed, and repented that he had neglected so great a man." (p. 146-147) Is firsthand experience the only way to judge a person's character? Does our character only count when we communicate it well to others?

WEEK 10

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 22

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 23

Daemons of Intellect

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the Hall of Simulation? Why and how is it a threat to Mansoul?

Today, we will read about the Daemons of Intellect. (Daemon is an old spelling for demon.) A daemon in our reading is a force, decision, or habit that takes something God created to be good and twists it into something unhealthy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.III p.45-47 "Like the Body" - "royal and magnanimous."

• DEFINITIONS

inertia: indisposition to motion, exertion, or change; the tendency to stay unmoving

jibs: to show hesitation or reluctance

coster's barrow: the wheelbarrow/cart of a fruit and vegetable seller

WEEK 11

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 23

The Ratification of the Constitution

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Our founders had met together over a very hot summer, and after much arguing, debating, and compromising, they had agreed upon the Constitution. Now, all they had to do was get the people of the states to agree on it, too! We'll read about that today.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.190-193

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: How to Ratify the Constitution

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

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Term 2

→ DISCUSS

Why do you think some people feared the new government and wanted protections from the government written into the Constitution?

WEEK 11

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 23

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 12 Agis and Cleomenes p. 148-153

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 10-11

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Alexandria in Egypt. This is where the entire final lesson takes place.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Twelve, Parts One through Three, p. 149-153. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the thirteen Spartans. Why would you choose to "die like a man" in a foreign street rather than surrender and try to live? (p. 152) What did Cleomenes understand in this moment about the difference between giving someone liberty and that person being capable of being free? Can a person be given freedom if they are already commanded by their own love of ease and safety?

→ WRITE

Panteus was the last to die. Cleomenes had commanded him to check each fallen man and die last of all. He did exactly that: walked among his friends, tested each one, and then fell on Cleomenes and slew himself. Think about what it means to be given one last duty by someone you loved and to carry it out after they are already gone. What does faithfulness look like at the very end of everything?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This is the end of two lives, Agis's half of the story ended in Lesson Three. Now Cleomenes's ends here. Ask students to look back across both men before discussing: what did they share, where did they differ, and what does Plutarch seem to think each man's story teaches?

WEEK 11

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 23

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Ourselves

WEEK 12

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)



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Term 2	
Questions will come from: Our Rugged Constitution	
WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 24 30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Exams Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15 PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson. → RECAP What happened in the last reading? → VIEW & DISCUSS Answer one of the exam questions. Include as much detail as you can remember.	
WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 25

My Lord Chief Explorer, Imagination

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Last term, we finished with a discussion about the Daemons of Intellect. Why is Habit considered one of these Daemons? What does it mean to have a Magnanimous Mind?

We will start our new term by learning more about the Lord Chief Explorer of Mansoul, Imagination. What do you recall about him from last term?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.IV p.48-51 "My Lord Chief" - "kind meantime!"

• DEFINITIONS

spinney: a small thicket of bushes or trees

fjord: a long, narrow sea inlet with steep sides or cliffs, created by a glacier

Sir Walter Scott: a Scottish novelist, poet, and playwright, and one of Mason's personal favorites

• COMPOSITION

When is Imagination a good servant? What does it act like when it is directed at Self?

WEEK 1

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 25

Amendment 1

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

PREP: You might want to read this article and share some thoughts with your student to give a little more background information about this idea of "separation of church and state" which is not found in the Constitution but stated often when discussing the First Amendment.

∞ Article Link: The History and Meaning Behind Separation of Church and State.

→ INTRO

Have you heard the phrase "separation of church and state"? What might that mean? It is not in the Constitution, but people often think it is because of the First Amendment. It was in a letter that President Thomas Jefferson wrote in 1802, a letter that said the establishment clause in the First Amendment should represent a "wall of separation" between church and state. We will explore what that means and how people might interpret it differently.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.196-197

2. Do you think a football coach has the right to kneel on the football field after a game at a public school and pray to God? The school didn't think so. He was fired from his job for refusing to stop this action and his case went all the way to the Supreme Court. We will read an article about the case and see what the Supreme Court decided after many years of legal battles.

∞ Article Link: At Long Last, a Victory for Coach Kennedy

• Do you agree with the Supreme Court's decision? Explain.

• Can you give examples of the other freedoms we have according to this amendment?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the safeguards given in the 1st Amendment in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what they mean.

→ NOTE

There is not time in this term's lessons to fully explore each Amendment. If interest is high, you will find many links and court cases for afternoon exploration and family discussions in Extra Helpings.

• EXTRA HELPING

The legal docket is a podcast highlighting cases brought to the Supreme Court. You can learn more about Kennedy v. Bremerton School District. (Audio or transcript)

∞ **Audio Link:** Legal Docket podcast

• **COMPOSITION** - Interview Coach Joe Kennedy about his Supreme Court case.

WEEK 1

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 25

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Introduction and Lesson 1 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 155-163

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 14-15

Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→VIEW

∞ Link: Retelling of Tiberius and Caius Gracchus (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)

∞ Image Link: Tiberius and Caius Gracchus

→LOCATE

Find Rome in the center of Italy. Locate Carthage in North Africa. Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus were the grandsons of Scipio Africanus, the Roman commander who defeated Hannibal at the Battle of Zama in 202 BC. Notice the distance between Rome and Africa; this family's influence spanned the Mediterranean world before the boys were even born.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson One, Prologue through Part Two, p. 160-163. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

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Term 3

→DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman citizen watching the two brothers walk through the Forum. Read the descriptions of the brothers on pages 161 and 162. Which brother would you trust more to lead a revolution, and why?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch notes that Cornelia's education of her sons "prevailed more than nature." (p. 161) Do you think a person's upbringing can entirely change their natural temperament?

WEEK 1

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 25

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 2

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 26

My Lord Chief Explorer, Imagination

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

In our last lesson, we had a more thorough introduction to Imagination. Why is Imagination important? Describe how it can be used unlawfully.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.IV p.51-53 "But the others" - "in your thoughts."

WEEK 2

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 26

Amendments 2-4

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ INTRO

Do you know what the Second Amendment is? This is a hotly debated topic that comes up a lot in the news. We will look at a recent case that was decided in June 2022 by the Supreme Court. You can listen to the podcast about it, which has the audio from the actual court case, or read the transcript.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.198-203

2. Read

∞ Article Link: Self-defense at the Supreme Court (stop at 9:30)

- What do you think the Supreme Court decided? (They decided in favor of Robert Nash. The vote was 6-3. The court said that New York's proper-cause requirement violates the Fourteenth Amendment by preventing law-abiding citizens with ordinary self-defense needs from exercising their Second Amendment right to keep and bear arms in public for self-defense.)

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 2nd-4th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

• EXTRA HELPING

Here is the link if you want to listen to the entire podcast about this case.

∞ Podcast Link: Jumping the Gun

WEEK 2

📅 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 26

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 2 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 165-167

📄 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p. 14-15

📄 Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?



Term 3

→ LOCATE

Find Carthage where Tiberius "was first to mount the walls." (p. 165) Find Numantia in the northern part of Hither Spain. This is rugged, difficult territory. Trace the long route from Rome, across the sea, and into the Spanish mountains. This is where Tiberius saved 20,000 Roman lives.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Two, Part One through Part Two, p. 165-167. Once finished, ask, 'What do you remember?' + 'What else?' Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman soldier trapped in the mountains of Numantia. Your Consul has failed, and you are surrounded. The enemies refuse to speak to anyone but Tiberius Gracchus. How does it feel to have your life depend on the reputation of one young officer? (p. 165)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

You are a Numantine governor. You have just captured the Roman army's entire payroll and the young officer's records. Your people hate Rome. Why do you treat this specific young man like a guest of honor instead of a prisoner of war? (p. 166)

WEEK 2

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 26

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 3

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 27

The Beauty Sense

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how to combat the Daemon of Self in regards to Imagination from our last lesson. Why must we take care to guard our imagination from unclean or horrible thoughts?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.V p.54-55 "The Beauty Sense" - "terror for us."

WEEK 3

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 27

Amendments 5-8

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Maybe you've heard anyone say, "I plead the fifth!" If so, you might know something about this next Amendment.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.204-211

Why do you think the Bill of Rights says so much about the rights of people who have to go to court?

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Term 3

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 5th -8th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 3

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 27

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 3 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 167-172

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Rome. Now, trace a line with your finger northward along the western coast toward the Alps. This region (modern-day Tuscany) is where Tiberius looked out at the vast estates. Imagine the "Roman Pink" on your map isn't a country owned by its people, but a giant puzzle where only a few wealthy men own all the pieces.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Three, Parts One - Three, p. 169-172. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a wealthy Senator. You bought land legally (or so you claim) years ago. Now, a young Tribune tells you that you must give it back to the poor. Tiberius says the soldiers "have nothing but air and light." (p. 171) How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you were a soldier who just returned from the wars in Spain, how would you respond to Tiberius' speech? (p. 171-172)

WEEK 3

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 27

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 4

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 28

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you recall from our last lesson about the Beauty Sense? How can we keep it in its right place?

Today, we will delve into a more thorough discussion of the Lord Chief Attorney-General of Mansoul: Reason. An attorney general is a position that usually serves as the main legal advisor to the government.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.56-58 "I have spoken" - "secretly entertained."

• DEFINITIONS

K.C.: the King's Counsel

The Tempest: a famous play by William Shakespeare in which a Duke named Prospero is set adrift to die by his brother, Antonio. Prospero shirked his responsibility as Duke in pursuit of the knowledge of magic and philosophy.

• COMPOSITION

Describe Reason.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 28

Amendments 9-10

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

We read a lot last time about the rights that our Constitution lists for people being accused of crimes. Today we will read about where our rights come from. Spoiler alert: it's not the government!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.212-217

On p.216 our book says, "The people have rights that come before the rights of the government. The people's rights come from God and cannot be taken away by human laws." What do you think of this statement?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 9th and 10th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 4

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 28

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 4 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 173-177

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Tiberius "sealed up" the gates of the Temple of Saturn in the city of Rome to stop the economy until his law was passed. (p. 175, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Four, Parts One - Two, p. 174-177. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Marcus Octavius, Tiberius's friend and fellow Tribune. You believe the land law is dangerous for Rome's stability. Your best friend is now asking the people to fire you from your job. How would you response?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius and Octavius were "vehement" against each other, but used no "foul words." (p. 174) Why do you think Plutarch chose to tell us that?

WEEK 4

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 28

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 29

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about how Reason behaves from our last lesson. Why do you think it is described as an attorney?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.58-60 "The good man's" - "long ago settled."

• DEFINITIONS

John Howard: the first reformer of the British prison system

WEEK 5

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 29

Amendments 11-13

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Last time, we read about where our rights come from. Today, we will read about when our country officially decided that those rights were for all people.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.220-227

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The 13th Amendment

• The video presents a controversial "loophole" of the 13th Amendment - forcing prisoners to work without pay. What are your thoughts on this issue?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 11th-13th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 5

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 29

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 5 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 177-182

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find the Kingdom of Pergamum (in modern-day Turkey/Asia Minor). King Attalus died and left his entire kingdom to Rome. Tiberius wanted to take that royal wealth and give it directly to the poor to buy tools for their new farms. "That made him again more hated of the Senate than before." (p. 180, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Five, Parts One - Three, p. 179-182. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a member of the Senate. Tiberius has just proposed that the inheritance of King Attalus should be "distributed among the poor citizens" to furnish them for their new farms. (p. 179) How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius said, "But when he goeth about to take away the authority and power of the people, then he is no more a tribune." (p. 181) Do you agree with that definition of leadership?

WEEK 5

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 29

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make

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Term 3

sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 30

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about how a good man's Reason operates? Why is Reason important for invention and innovation?

Today, we will hear about what happens when Reason is viewed as the highest possible aim.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.60-62 "It is very" - "the reasoning begins."

• COMPOSITION

Give some examples of Reason working its way out in your life or in your community.

WEEK 6

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 30

Amendment 14

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How does someone become a citizen of the United States? Do you know someone born in another country who became a US citizen? We will read about that today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.228-235

Here are the requirements for becoming a naturalized citizen:

- Be at least 18 years old
- Be a legal resident of the United States for 3-5 or more years
- Be of good moral character and be loyal to the United States
- Be able to read, write, and speak basic English
- Pass a naturalization test
- Take the Oath of Allegiance at a naturalization ceremony

→ READ

Do you think you could pass the Naturalization Test? Look at some of the questions to see what people need to know about the US before becoming citizens.

∞ Article Link: Questions for Naturalization Test

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 14th Amendment in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

• EXTRA HELPING

Brown v. Board of Education is a landmark Supreme Court case decided by the 14th Amendment.
∞ Video Link: Brown v. Board of Education

WEEK 6

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 30

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 6 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 182-187

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

Map Resource: Roman Republic 31 B.C.

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Rome. Here "were slain above three hundred men," including Tiberius (p. 187, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

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Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Five, Parts One - Three, p. 183-187. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a supporter of Tiberius. You see him touch his head to signal he is in danger, but "his enemies seeing the sign he gave, ran presently to the Senate, and declared that Tiberius desired the people to bestow a crown upon him, as if this were the meaning of his touching his head." (p. 186) Suddenly, a mob of Senators comes charging out of the meeting, armed with broken chair legs. Do you stay to fight, or do you flee?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius was killed by a fellow Tribune with the "foot of a chair." (p. 186) Plutarch notes that not one man was killed with an "iron weapon." (p. 187) Why do you think Plutarch pointed this out?

WEEK 6

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 30

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 7

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 31

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the dangers of viewing Reason as infallible. How are two sensible people able to come to equally good but opposing conclusions on the same subject?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.62-65 "We have all been" - "anything they see."

WEEK 7

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 31

Amendments 15 and 16

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In 1913, two very important amendments were passed. One changed how Senators are elected. The other established a Federal Income Tax. (I wonder how popular that one was!)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.236-241

What do you think would happen if there was no Federal Income tax?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 15th-17th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 7

📅 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 31

📅 30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 7 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 187-192

📄 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

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Term 3

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Rome in Italy. The Tiber River flows through it, though it is not labeled on this map. This is where the victors threw Tiberius's body, denying him a burial. Now find Sardinia, the island to the southwest. This is where Gaius was sent as Quaestor to keep him away from the political fires in Rome.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Seven, Parts One - Two, p. 189-191. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius Gracchus. Your brother is dead, his friends were executed, and you have just had a dream where Tiberius tells you, "Brother, why dost thou prolong time... we were both predestined to one manner of life and death." (p. 191) How do you feel about the dream?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says of Gaius that "some were of opinion that he was more popular, and desirous of the common people's good will and favour, than his brother had been before him." (p. 191) Do you think it was a compliment?

WEEK 7

📅 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 31

Tracker: 📅 📅 📅 📅 📅

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

• What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 8

📅 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 32

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

📄 Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the relationship between Reason and the Will from our last lesson.

Today, we will explore the Desires, which Mason refers to as the Lords of the Exchequer. The Exchequer is a British name for the government department responsible for the oversight and collection of revenue; in other words, the Treasury.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.66-68 "We consider" - "duly balanced."

• **DEFINITIONS**
approbation: approval

WEEK 8

📅 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 32

Amendment 17 and 18

📄 Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

From the years 1920-1933, due to the 18th Amendment, the production and sale of alcohol was prohibited. The Temperance (means abstaining from alcohol) Movement was a group of people that fought for this amendment for many years because of the negative effects that drunkenness had on families and work environments. This time period is called Prohibition. Although many



Term 3

people followed this law, there were many others who made alcohol illegally and there were even clubs called speakeasies where people would drink alcohol. It was a hard law to enforce. In 1933, the 21st Amendment repealed it, and it was no longer illegal to buy and sell alcohol. The states could make their own laws about the sale of alcohol.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-243

- What does the Bible say about the drinking of alcohol?
- Why do you think it was a hard law to enforce?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 17th and 18th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 8

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 32

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 8 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 192-197

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Rome in Italy. The Field of Mars lies just outside its walls, though it is not labeled on this map. Plutarch says so many people came to vote for Gaius that "the Field of Mars not being large enough to hold such a multitude of people, there were that gave their voices upon the top of houses." (p. 194, The Plutarch Project Volume 3) Now find Sardinia to the southwest. This is where Gaius "not only excelled all the young men of his age in his actions against his enemies" but also "in temperance, frugality, and industry, he surpassed those who were much older than himself." (p. 193)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One - Three, p. 193-197. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the censors hearing Gaius defend himself. He tells you he "alone of all men else that had been in the wars, had carried his purse full, and brought it home empty: where others having drunk the wine which they carried thither in vessels, had afterwards brought them home full of gold and silver." (p. 194) What do you think about his defense?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says that where all other orators turned toward the Senate, Gaius "in contrary manner when he made his oration, turned him outwards towards the other side of the marketplace." (p. 196-197) Plutarch calls it "a little turning." What do you think it meant?

WEEK 8

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 32

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

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WEEK 9

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 33

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you recall from our last lesson about how the natural desire for approval can serve us? How can it become the Daemons of Vanity and Fame?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.68-70 "Another Desire" - "spend his money."

• DEFINITIONS

on his mettle: being ready or forced to prove your ability

WEEK 9

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 33

Amendments 19-22

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Have you heard the term suffrage? It comes from Latin and has to do with the right to vote. So people who fight for the right to vote are suffragists.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.244-253

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Watch this 5 minute video about the 19th Amendment.

∞ Video Link: 19th Amendment

- Why do you think the western states were the first to allow women the right to vote?
- How did WW1 impact the 19th Amendment?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 9

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 33

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 9 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 197-202

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Find Capua. This was one of the major cities where Gaius wanted to send poor citizens to live.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Nine, Parts One - Two, p. 199-202. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch writes, "He won the good will of the common people, being more popular and familiar in his conversation and deeds than he was otherwise in his orations" (p. 200). Consider the Lives we have studied this year. What role does a person's personality play in their success?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

The Senate has hired a rival, Livius Drusus, to "play the demagogue" and outbid you. While you offer two colonies for the "honestest citizens," he offers twelve colonies for the "poorest," letting them have the land "scot free." (p. 201) As Gaius, how do you defend your laws in this situation?

WEEK 9

15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 33

Tracker: □ □ □ □ □

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 10

25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 34

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the Desire of Excelling from our last reading? What things are worthy (and unworthy) of our pursuit? Why?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.70-72 "As before" - "for our own."

• DEFINITIONS

avarice: greed

• COMPOSITION

Describe some good and bad outcomes of Desire for Wealth or Power.

WEEK 10

30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 34

Amendments 23-24

Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Voting is an extremely important right in a democratic republic. Today we will read more about how the Constitution protects that right.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.254-257

How do you think it felt to live in Washington DC and not be able to vote in Presidential races? Are there any circumstances today that might keep some people from voting?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 23rd and 24th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 10

30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 34

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 10 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 202-206

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Look at the sea south of Capua. Gaius sailed across this water to Carthage to build a city named "Junonia." While there, a storm blew away his sacrifices and wolves stole his boundary marks. (p. 204-205, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Ten, Parts One - Two, p. 203-205. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius, back in Rome. You see one of your "familiar friends" being dragged to prison by the Consul's officers. You have promised to protect your allies, but you "pass by without assisting him," claiming you don't want to pick a quarrel. What are you thinking? (p. 205)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch wrote, Gaius, "came now to take a house near the marketplace, to show himself nearby the lowlier and more popular." (p. 205) Why do you think he moved?



Term 3

WEEK 10 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 34

Tracker: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

News source of your choice
PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 35

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH-UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 35

Amendments 25-26

☐ Materials: Our Rugged Constitution

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

One of today's amendments changed the minimum voting age from 21 to 18. During the Vietnam War, our country drafted young men to fight for our country who were not old enough to vote. Let's read about the Amendment that changed that.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.258-262

Approximately 11,848 amendments to the Constitution have been proposed through 2019, averaging over 100 annually!

2. Read these examples of proposed amendments. Do you think these 5 should be enacted? Can you think of others you might suggest?

∞ Document Link: Proposed Amendments to the Constitution

∞ Document Link: Five Proposed Amendments

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Write down the 25th and 26th Amendments in your own words or in bullet points. Draw a picture or symbol to represent what it means.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 35

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Lesson 11 Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus - p. 206-216

☐ Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Look at the city of Rome. The conflict has now moved from laws and speeches to the streets themselves. Visualize the Capitol, where both parties met "by break of day." The peace is broken when an attendant named Antyllus is slain with "great bodkins to write with" rather than swords. (p. 209, The Plutarch Project Volume 3)

→ READ, NARRATE

Lesson Eleven, Parts One - Two, p. 208-211 and Lesson Twelve, Parts One - Epilogue, p. 212-215. Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR - PICK 1

Plutarch wrote, "Gaius would not arm himself, but went out of his house in a long gown, as if he would have gone simply into the marketplace." (p. 210) What do you think about his choices?

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Term 3

You are a guest at Cornelia's home in Misenum. She tells the story of her sons' deaths "without shedding a tear," as if she were telling a history of someone else. Some guests think she has lost her "reason and sense" from grief. Do you agree? (p. 215)

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Gaius' wife says, "Alas, what hope or trust is left us now, in laws or gods, since they have slain Tiberius?" (p. 211) What kind of loss do you think she is describing?

The people eventually built statues of the Gracchi and "consecrated the places where they had been slain." Looking back at their lives, did the Gracchi brothers "win" or "lose" their battle for the Roman people? Why? (p. 215)

WEEK 11 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 35

Tracker:

News source of your choice

PREP: Preview news source

→ INTRO

Let's scan the headlines and see what is in the news. What sounds interesting to you? Let's make sure we read a variety of stories. (sports, arts and leisure, politics, op-eds, world news, local news).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

News story

- What are your thoughts? What sources do they cite? Is there an obvious bias? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?

→ LOCATE

Look at a map and find where the events occurred

→ NOTEBOOK

Write the date and summary of the event in the Current Events section of your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Ourselves

WEEK 12 30m American Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Our Rugged Constitution

WEEK 12 30m Plutarch: Grades 6-8 - Lesson 36

30m Plutarch: Grade 9 - Exams

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas, p. 14-15

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Answer one of the exam questions. Include as much detail as you can remember.

WEEK 12 15m Current Events: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

American Government: Grade 7

- Our Rugged Constitution: Tell all you know about the powers of Congress.

Ethics: Part 1

- Ourselves: Book I: Describe the work of two "Esquires of the Body" (appetites), and show that these Esquires must be servants, not masters, in Mansoul. OR Tell about some of the perils of Mansoul.

Term 2

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

American Government: Grade 7

- Our Rugged Constitution: Tell all you know about one of the branches of the government and the qualifications, roles, and limits for that position.

Ethics: Part 1

- Ourselves: Book I: Show that the sense of touch is a useful servant but a bad master. How may we get a "hearing ear?" Mention some sounds that you have enjoyed this term. OR How do the Beauty Sense and Imagination help assist Intellect in his travels?

Term 3

Current Events: Grades 5-8

- Tell the story of one of the news events of this term.

American Government: Grade 7

- Our Rugged Constitution: Pick one of the rights that citizens have according to the First Amendment (freedom of religion, speech, press, and assembly) and explain what that means, and provide examples of what is allowed according to that right.

Ethics: Part 1

- Ourselves: Book I: Tell that the Desires of (a) approbation, (b) wealth, and (c) power have their uses and their dangers. Give examples from books you have read, if possible. OR Describe the benefits of Reason, as well as the dangers of depending upon it.